Start-Up Plan: IntelliEstate

Chosen Legal Form:

BV (Besloten Vennootschap) — Private Limited Company (Belgium)

Motivation for my choice

I chose a BV (Besloten Vennootschap) because it's the most professional and secure option for my type of business. Since I work with data and AI services, I need legal protection and credibility. A BV is a separate legal entity, so if something goes wrong, like debts or data issues, I'm not personally responsible beyond what I invested. It also looks more reliable to other companies when sending invoices or signing contracts.

Financially, a BV is smarter in the long run. It pays corporate tax (25%) instead of high personal income tax, and I can keep profits inside the company to reinvest or pay out later as dividends. It also allows me to own my technology, apply for R&D tax benefits, and bring in investors or partners easily.

Overall, a BV helps me run the company seriously, plan for growth, and build trust with future clients and investors.

Business Plan

My company, **IntelliEstate**, helps real estate agencies use artificial intelligence to work more efficiently. Many agencies lose sales because they don't have a system that quickly connects what a client wants with the right properties. They often use manual tools or outdated software, which slows them down.

The solution: IntelliEstate provides an AI infrastructure that runs on data the real estate industry already has (property listings, client preferences, and past transactions). The AI analyzes this data to automatically match people with available homes and generate personalized follow-up messages. This saves time for agents and helps them close more deals.

How it works

1. Data connection: The agency connects its listings and client database to our platform.
2. AI matching: The AI reads and understands client needs (location, budget, size) and compares them to the available homes.
3. Results: It shows the best matches instantly and can send automated, personalized messages to clients.
4. Feedback: The more the agency uses it, the better the system becomes at predicting what people are looking for.

So instead of agents doing this manually, the AI does it in seconds. The goal is to help agencies work faster, improve communication, and avoid losing potential buyers.

Why the BV fits this plan

Benefit	Explanation
Limited liability	Protects personal finances if the business fails.
Professional image	Boosts trust with agencies and investors.
Tax advantage	25% corporate tax vs higher personal income rates.
IP ownership	BV legally owns AI models and client data systems.
Scalable	Easy to attract partners/investors through shares.

Target market

We focus on mid-sized real estate agencies, companies that are too small to build their own AI system but large enough to need automation. These are usually agencies with 10–200 employees, who manage multiple listings and clients at once.

Sales approach

We reach new clients through cold calling and email outreach. Our message is simple and creates urgency:

“Your competitors are already using our AI system; we can show you how it works for free.”

We then offer them a free trial, where they can actually see the system in action using their own data. Once they experience the improvement, faster matching, more organized leads, and higher conversion, most will continue as paying customers.

Revenue model

Our system works on a monthly subscription basis.

Plan	Description	Monthly Price	Yearly Price
Starter	Up to 500 listings, AI matching only	€250/month	€2,700/year
Professional	Up to 2,000 listings, automated messages & dashboard	€600/month	€6,480/year
Enterprise	Unlimited listings, analytics, and support	Custom	Custom

Feasibility

This business is realistic because it uses technology that already exists (AI models, APIs, and data tools). We don't need to build everything from scratch; we integrate and customize these systems for real estate. That means lower development costs and faster results. We also use the data agencies already have, so onboarding is easy. Success stories from early clients will help us attract more agencies without heavy marketing costs.

Offer – Products and Services

IntelliEstate provides AI tools and infrastructure that help real estate agencies work faster and close more sales. Our system uses the agency's existing data to automate matching, communication, and analysis.

1. AI Matching System:
    a. Automatically matches clients with suitable properties based on their preferences (location, budget, size). It learns from previous results and helps agents find the right homes instantly.
2. Automated Communication:
    a. Generates and sends personalized follow-up messages to clients, saving agents time and improving lead conversion.
3. Performance Dashboard
    a. Gives real-time insights into which listings perform best and how to optimize sales and marketing efforts.

4. Integration and Support
    a. We help agencies connect the AI to their systems, train staff, and provide ongoing technical support.
5. Free Trial

    Agencies can test the system with their own data for free. Once they see results, they can continue with a monthly subscription.

How I set my pricing

Pricing Strategy	Application to IntelliEstate
Cost-based	I start by covering my direct expenses: software licenses, hosting, AI APIs, and marketing (~€500/month). Then I add my minimum income goal.
Competitor-based	Competitors like CINC or Luxury Presence charge between €400 and €1,000/month. I positioned IntelliEstate slightly below, at **€600/month**, to stay competitive while signaling quality.
Value-based	My pricing reflects the *value created* for clients: if the AI helps one agency close an extra €3,000–€5,000 sale per month, the €600 subscription is a fraction of the return.

This balanced method ensures my price covers costs, fits market expectations, and justifies its worth based on the client's results.

Cost Calculation

IntelliEstate's main costs are:

- Labor: My own time (development, outreach, support)
- Software & Licenses: AI APIs, hosting, and data tools
- Marketing & Sales: Website, ads, cold outreach
- Administrative: Accounting, legal setup (BV), insurance
- Profit Margin: 25–30%

Estimated monthly costs (start-up phase):
→ €500 software + €200 marketing + €100 administration = €800/month
Adding a 30% margin = €1,040 minimum viable monthly rate.

So, any price above €1,040/month for all clients combined ensures profitability.

My Pricing Offer

Plan	Description	Monthly Price	Yearly Price
Starter	Up to 500 listings, AI matching	€250	€2,700
Professional	Up to 2,000 listings, automation & dashboard	€600	€6,480
Enterprise	Unlimited listings, analytics, priority support	Custom	Custom

Financial Impact as a Student Entrepreneur (Belgium, 2025)

As a student running IntelliEstate under a BV structure, I must still consider income tax and social contributions, especially if I draw income from the business.

Social Contributions (2025 Thresholds)

- Below €8,504.44/year → no contributions (if exemption requested)
- Between €8,504.44–€17,008.88 → 20.5% on income above €8,504.44
- Above €17,008.88 → full 20.5% on total income (same as full-time self-employed)

As a student entrepreneur, this means:

- I move beyond the low-income exemption, so I must pay social contributions.
- I might lose family allowance if I exceed the €17,000 threshold.
- However, I gain entrepreneurial status, business credibility, and tax-deductible expenses.

Why This Matters for Pricing

Because of taxes and contributions, I must price my services high enough to:

1. Cover my real costs (software, marketing, admin)
2. Leave profit after social contributions
3. Still create room for reinvestment inside my BV

That's why my Professional plan (€600/month) isn't just random — it reflects:

- A realistic value-based outcome (client ROI)
- A cost buffer for taxes and contributions
- A profit margin that supports reinvestment and growth

Minimum Viable Rate

Step	Calculation	Result (annual)
1. Desired personal income	€12,000	€12,000
2. + Business expenses (software, marketing, admin)	+ €8,000	€20,000
3. + Taxes & social contributions (~40% buffer)	+ €8,000	€28,000
Total required turnover		€28,000 / year

Minimum Viable Rate (MVR) Calculation

The MVR shows how much revenue IntelliEstate must generate per hour to stay sustainable after costs, taxes, and the limits of billable hours.

Step 1 – Desired annual income

- Target personal income → €12 000/year

Step 2 – Add business expenses

- Software + hosting + AI APIs + marketing + accounting = €8 000/year
  Subtotal → €12 000 + €8 000 = €20 000

Step 3 – Estimate billable hours

- 40 h / week × 48 weeks = 1 920 h total
- 50 % billable → 960 billable hours/year

Step 4 – Add taxes & social contributions

- ≈ 40 % of profit reserved for tax + social security
  €20 000 × 1.4 = €28 000 turnover needed

Step 5 – Compute MVR

Formula	Result
€28 000 ÷ 960 billable hours	**≈ €29 per hour (minimum viable rate)**

Step 6 – Translate to monthly & client goals

Metric	Calculation	Result
Monthly revenue target	€28 000 ÷ 12	≈ €2 333 / month
Clients (Professional plan €600 / mo)	€2 333 ÷ €600	≈ 4 clients

My offer model

1. One-time Onboarding & Integration — covers data connection, CRM import, initial model tuning, 6–12 hours of setup & training.
   → Price suggestion: €1,200 one-off.

2. Subscription (monthly recurring) - three tiers:
   Starter — up to 500 listings, basic matching, 1 user, email support. €250 / month

    - Professional — up to 2,000 listings, automated messaging, dashboard, 5–10 users, monthly performance call. €600 / month

    - Enterprise — custom limits, SLA, API access, priority support, analytics. Custom / from €1,800+ / month

3. Optional Success Fee (small, performance-aligned) — optional add-on to signal confidence and share risk. Example: €200 per verified extra closed deal generated through the system in a month, capped or negotiated quarterly; OR 2–5% of incremental revenue directly attributable to IntelliEstate (needs clear attribution rules).

4. Contract terms: minimum 3–6 months (6 preferred), 30-day notice after minimum, invoices monthly in advance (or annually with 10% discount).

Why does this beat the alternatives?

- Value-based + predictable: Subscriptions show value monthly and let clients justify cost relative to closed deals.

- Covers real costs immediately: Onboarding pays for integration hours (so you're not subsidizing setup).

- Scales without linear effort: Each new client mostly uses cloud AI, with a low marginal cost.

- Easy sales ask: "€600/month + €1,200 onboarding, we'll show you value in your first 14 days."

- Low admin for a BV: Clear recurring invoices, simple bookkeeping; VAT handled per invoice.

- Student entrepreneur fit: You avoid selling hours at low rates; subscription revenue helps you reach the MVR (€2,333/mo) with ~4–5 Professional clients.

Competition analysis

SWOT Analysis

Competitor	Strengths	Weaknesses	Opportunities for IntelliEstate	Threats
Luxury Presence	Strong brand and advanced AI marketing tools (SEO, lead generation, content automation).	Focuses only on marketing; not built for property-matching or operations.	Focus on property-matching automation — a gap in their service.	Could expand into operations using their large client base.
CINC	Proven CRM and AI for lead nurturing; strong integrations.	Lacks deep property-matching features.	Add-on potential — my AI can improve the lead-to-listing connection.	May develop matching features internally.
Lofty	All-in-one CRM with AI assistant and automation tools.	Broad focus, less specialized in property recommendation.	Integrate or outperform with higher accuracy in matching.	Might add stronger matching features and reduce demand.
Reonomy	Excellent property data intelligence, strong analytics in commercial real estate.	Not focused on residential or agency workflows.	Using a Reonomy-style data structure, but for residential matching.	Could expand to residential, leveraging existing data.
Virtual Staging AI	Easy-to-use visual enhancement tool for property photos.	Very narrow use case, only staging visuals.	Combine matching with visuals for a complete AI package.	Could expand into workflow automation later.

Summary Competitor Analysis

Through analyzing competitors like Luxury Presence, CINC, Lofty, Reonomy, and Virtual Staging AI, I've learned how each focuses on a different part of the real estate technology market. Most of them build tools around marketing, CRM, or data intelligence, but very few address the operational gap between client demand and property availability. This helped me see where IntelliEstate can stand out by specializing in AI property matching and automation instead of trying to compete with large, established platforms. I also realized that these competitors aren't just threats; they could become future partners if our system integrates well with their tools. Understanding their strengths and weaknesses gives me a clearer idea of how to position IntelliEstate in the market and how to communicate its unique value to agencies.

Competitive Advantage

- Low investment and high flexibility (software-based, scalable)
- Ownership and decision power (full control under BV)
- Less administration than larger legal forms
- Strong credibility for signing B2B contracts

Invoicing for InteliEstate

INVOICE

Seller:		**Bill to:**	
IntelliEstate BV		Company X BVBA	
Prins Boudewijnlaan 12 2000 Antwerp Belgium		Prins Boudewijnlaan 21G 2550 Kontich Belgium	
VAT: BE 1234.567.890 Bank: KBC Bank IBAN: BE00 1234 5678 9012 BIC: TESTBEBB			
Email: hello@intelliestate.example Phone: +32 475 00 00 00			
Invoice number:	IE-2025-011		
Invoice date:	2025-10-14		
Due date:	2025-10-27		

Description	Qty	Unit Price (EUR)	Line Total (EUR)
One-time Onboarding & Integration — data connection, CRM import, initial model tuning	1	1200	1200
Professional subscription — 1 month — AI matching, automation, dashboard & support (Professional plan)	1	600	600
		Total excl. VAT:	**1800**
		Subtotal (EUR):	**1800**
		VAT (21%):	378
		Total due (EUR):	**2178**

Small-business VAT exemption:
If your company is eligible for the small-business VAT exemption in Belgium, please notify IntelliEstate BV in writing. An adjusted invoice without VAT can be issued.
Reference: IE-2025-011

General conditions:
Payment due within 14 days of invoice date. Late payments incur 1% interest per month and a €25 administrative fee. All services are subject to IntelliEstate BV terms and a Data Processing Agreement (DPA). Disputes are subject to the courts of Antwerp.

IP & IntelliEstate

Intellectual property is very relevant for IntelliEstate because the company is built on original software, AI systems, and data-driven branding. Protecting these assets early is essential to prevent others from copying or claiming them (Traverse Legal, 2025). As a Belgian technology company, IntelliEstate also operates within a national policy that aims to strengthen IP, IT, and data law between 2025 and 2029, which supports innovation but also increases the need for legal compliance (PwC Legal, 2025).

Software and AI Models

The main value of IntelliEstate comes from its software, algorithms, and how its AI learns from real estate data. These elements are automatically protected by copyright, but the company must keep dated records of its work and make sure that all contributors legally assign their rights to the BV (Traverse Legal, 2025). Clear IP ownership builds company value and investor trust.

Copyright

Everything created by IntelliEstate, such as code, designs, and written content, is covered by copyright law. However, if parts of the output are generated automatically by AI, ownership may be harder to prove. Maintaining human input in the creation process helps secure copyright protection (Traverse Legal, 2025).

Trademark

The company name, IntelliEstate, and its logo should be registered as a trademark to protect the brand identity and prevent confusion with similar businesses. Trademark registration in Belgium can be done through the Benelux Office for Intellectual Property (BOIP) and later extended to the EU level. This adds credibility and legal protection across markets (PwC Legal, 2025).

Trade Secrets

Certain parts of IntelliEstate's system, such as its matching algorithms, datasets, and analytics methods, should be kept as trade secrets. This involves storing them securely and requiring employees or contractors to sign confidentiality agreements. Taking active steps to protect confidential information is a legal requirement for trade secret protection (Traverse Legal, 2025).

Licensing and Client Data

Because IntelliEstate's system relies on data from real estate agencies, it must follow GDPR and include clear data clauses in its contracts. These agreements should define who owns the data, how it can be used, and what happens when the partnership ends. Proper data licensing helps prevent disputes and supports ethical data use (PwC Legal, 2025; Rentastic, 2024).

Patent

At this stage, IntelliEstate does not need to file for a patent unless it develops a new and unique AI technology. Patents can be costly and require public disclosure. For now, the company's best protection comes from trade secrets, copyright, and contractual agreements (Traverse Legal, 2025).

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